“Sure,” I said, “the man who has the job has more experience than anyone else . . . that’s why I’m running.”

Pat Brown brought Senator Edward Kennedy to California to help him campaign, and he began a speaking trip around the state declaring, “Reagan has never held any political office before and here he is seeking the top spot in the government of California.”

He abandoned that theme after my next speech, when I said, “I understand there’s a senator from Massachusetts who’s come to California and he’s concerned that I’ve never held office prior to seeking this job. Well, you know, come to think of it, the senator from Massachusetts never held *any* job before he became a senator.”

Still, I realized that if I didn’t handle it right, the “he’s only an actor” theme could hurt me. I knew a lot of people had misconceptions about actors: If you’re an actor, the only thing you can do is act. . . . Yes, you’ve played a lot of parts on the screen, but it’s only make-believe and that’s *all* you can do: pretend. . . . Those who can, do; those who can’t, act.

Being an actor who was running for political office wasn’t all drawbacks: Many people develop an affection and feelings of friendship for someone they enjoy on the screen, and that could be an advantage for me.

Nevertheless, I knew I had to prove I had more to offer than a familiar face.

One of Brown’s favorite ploys was to say, “Reagan is only an actor who memorizes speeches written by other people, just like he memorized the lines that were fed to him by his screenwriters in the movies. Sure, he makes a good speech, but who’s *writing* his speeches?”

Well, *I* was writing my speeches. But I couldn’t get up and say to an audience, “Hey, I write my own speeches.”

We called a meeting and Stu Spencer and Bill Roberts, who were managing the campaign, said that Brown was